

Stanford University

Winter 2023 Section Feedback

Course: W23-ECON-155-01: ENVIRONMENTAL ECONOMICS & POLI
Instructor: Helen Kissel *,Justin Young
Response Rate: 57/73 (78.08 %)

Question		1	2	3	4	5	6	7
In what way did you interact with this instructor most?: Helen Kissel	n	27	0	0	0	0	0	0
	%	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Scale: 1 = In section meetings, 2 = In lab, 3 = During office hours, 4 = Via a class website, 5 = Email, 6 = In class, 7 = Other

Question	During the quarter, about how many hours on average per week did you interact with this instructor in section, class, lab, office hours, and other meetings?: Helen Kissel						n	%
1							16	66.67%
2							6	25.00%
3							1	4.17%
5							1	4.17%
Mean							1.50	
Std							0.93	
Median							1.00	

Question		5	4	3	2	1	Mean	Std	Median
How much did you learn from this instructor?: Helen Kissel	n	19	4	2	0	0	4.68	0.63	5.00
	%	76.00%	16.00%	8.00%	0.00%	0.00%			

Scale: 5 = A great deal, 4 = A lot, 3 = A moderate amount, 2 = A little, 1 = Nothing

Question		5	4	3	2	1	Mean	Std	Median
Overall, how effective was the instruction you received from this instructor?: Helen Kissel	n	20	3	1	0	0	4.79	0.51	5.00
	%	83.33%	12.50%	4.17%	0.00%	0.00%			

Scale: 5 = Extremely effective, 4 = Very effective, 3 = Moderately effective, 2 = Slightly effective, 1 = Not effective at all

What skills or knowledge did you learn or improve from this instructor?: Helen Kissel

- She is very thoughtful and engaged and very good at explaining concepts.
- Generally improving my understanding of key class concepts
- Helen is all around an incredible TA. She responds so quickly to emails with questions, invests the time and effort to clarify all questions I had, and was just generally one of the best TAs I've had. Couldn't recommend her more as a TA!
- Writing and the environment
- Analysis based on economic models learned in class
- I developed my analytical, critical thinking, and logical reasoning skills.
- how to approach graphs for environmental econ, how to work through problems
- I was able to greatly solidify my knowledge of course content from Helen.
- How to do well in the class
- Understanding concepts in published economics papers; conceptualizing abstract concepts like VSL.
- Helen is the goat! Great teacher, learned os much about econ.
- -quantitatively evaluating environmental economic problems
- Further understanding of class topics and their applications
- Helen was super helpful in understanding the concepts from class. Truly, her section was so important for the solidification of concepts taught that week, and often I felt I understood the key concepts better when she illustrated them than I did during lecture. She provided great overviews of key concepts, critical mathematical procedures and/or graphs, and important information.

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What aspects of this instructor's teaching were most helpful to you?: Helen Kissel

- Approachable Clear Worked hard to make us learn
- Slides/delivery of information, working through problem set questions, checking the room to make sure that section is progressing at the right pace
- Very organized delivery of content!
- Great teaching style, accessible office hours, and excellent course knowledge.
- Really good at explaining things and her notes are very helpful and detailed.
- walking through practice problems in section, being flexible with turning in assignments, midterm and final review sessions
- Helen was incredibly well-versed in the content and would follow up with students if on questions she wasn't able to initially answer. Helen was always super helpful and never hesitated to offer additional help to students if they needed it.
- Kind
- Thorough explanation of concepts in the slides + of practice problems.
- She's empathetic and understanding. Her sections are very helpful.
- -kindness -responsiveness over email -great at breaking concepts down -facilitation of in-class discussion -effort put into helping students review for midterms and exams
- Aspect 1: She provided concise and straightforward explanations of concepts that often felt convoluted in lecture. Her explanations in class catered to every level of understanding, and she made sure to get both into the basic components of idea, particularly graphical representations, and also the more complex applications. Aspect 2: Helen was very open to questions, and whenever I asked them, I felt satisfied I got a good answer, which isn't always the case. I particularly appreciated how she worked through them with me and didn't just regurgitate a prewritten solution. Aspect 3: Helen's background was very interesting, and I enjoyed learning about her research. I think her coming from a different realm of economic research was also really pivotal in aiding her teaching. She did a really good job of establishing foundations and not assuming our understanding, which I think partly comes from learning some of these concepts, yourself.

How can this instructor's teaching be improved?: Helen Kissel

- Nothing really!
- N/A!
- Nothing!
- Very enthusiastic and a good presenter! Clearly has a strong economics background, but not in environmental economics... would be amazing to take a class from her in her area of expertise.
- None
- Helen was really thorough!
- n/a

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Fall 2021 Section Feedback

Course: F21-ECON-155-01: ENVIRONMENTAL ECONOMICS & POLI

Instructor: Nick Grasley, Helen Kissel *

Response Rate: 60/76 (78.95 %)

Question		1	2	3	4	5	6	7
In what way did you interact with this instructor most?: Helen Kissel	n	32	0	1	0	0	0	0
	%	96.97%	0.00%	3.03%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Scale: 1 = In section meetings, 2 = In lab, 3 = During office hours, 4 = Via a class website, 5 = Email, 6 = In class, 7 = Other

Question	During the quarter, about how many hours on average per week did you interact with this instructor in section, class, lab, office hours, and other meetings?: Helen Kissel						n	%
1							23	71.88%
2							5	15.63%
3							2	6.25%
5							1	3.13%
6							1	3.13%
Mean							1.56	
Std							1.19	
Median							1.00	

Question		5	4	3	2	1	Mean	Std	Median
How much did you learn from this instructor?: Helen Kissel	n	20	10	3	0	0	4.52	0.67	5.00
	%	60.61%	30.30%	9.09%	0.00%	0.00%			

Scale: 5 = A great deal, 4 = A lot, 3 = A moderate amount, 2 = A little, 1 = Nothing

Question		5	4	3	2	1	Mean	Std	Median
Overall, how effective was the instruction you received from this instructor?: Helen Kissel	n	19	12	2	0	0	4.52	0.62	5.00
	%	57.58%	36.36%	6.06%	0.00%	0.00%			

Scale: 5 = Extremely effective, 4 = Very effective, 3 = Moderately effective, 2 = Slightly effective, 1 = Not effective at all

What skills or knowledge did you learn or improve from this instructor?: Helen Kissel

- how to understand the graphs in more detail
- Graphs and analysis
- Going over lecture content
- Helen is a great TA. She helped me understand all the main concepts in this course.
- More about the environment and how to approach the problems on the psats
- Environmental economics and policy
- Understanding models in class and understanding externalities, graphs, data
- She was great in section at going over material from lecture, and helped with my research paper
- Practice applying the concepts, clarifying questions from class.
- Critical thinking
- Refined my knowledge of general concepts.
- She helped me understand and apply class concepts really well.
- Helen did a fantastic job relating lecture material to problems sets and exams. It was difficult to pinpoint exactly how lecture material would be used in an exam however section did a great job bridging the gap
- learned the inner workings of the psats
- more clarity on whatever concepts we learned in lecture that week
- Environmental economics concepts and policies
- all the course material, helped clarify everything
- how to think through confusing problems
- Helen really helped in re-emphasizing the concepts learned in lecture and was really helpful in understanding the graphs!!
- I felt that section with Helen was honestly more helpful at times than attending lecture. She helped me improve my understanding of the different econ policies we covered during class and understand how the models actually worked.
- I learned about carbon offsets, reviewed material from classes such as cap and trade, externalities, fisheries, etc.

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Instructor: Nick Grasley, Helen Kissel *
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What aspects of this instructor's teaching were most helpful to you?: Helen Kissel

- Aspect 1: knowledge Aspect 2: kindness/approachability Aspect 3: commitment to following up
- Section in general; practice problems; answering questions
- Great at responding to emails, scheduling outside help, and answering questions
- she is very approachable, helpful, and attentive.
- Going over problems from the pset Covering more aspects related to what was presented in class
- Everything
- Very organized, thoughtful, allows for healthy participation
- going over problem set questions, going over stuff from lecture
- Good examples, willingness to admit if she didn't know and didn't want to give a wrong answer, help grasping tricky concepts.
- Flexibility to answer specific questions in section
- She explained things really simply and intuitively She was always available either via email or zoom to talk if I had any questions She seemed very approachable and acted like she cared about her students
- Helen had really organized sections and notes, and summed up the week's lectures really well!
- drawing graphs! pulling in outside examples of the things we were learning that week
- Great job with the section content and really focusing on the concepts that were super important. Sometimes Goulder's lectures can get a bit long-winded and its easy to tune out. I appreciated how concisely and clearly section condensed lecture content.
- Very approachable and nice. Will point you in the right direction when you are stuck.
- positive energy, identifying and reviewing the most difficult material, great job simplifying problems
- Willingness to answer questions and provide help
- willingness to meet and help, answering questions kindly/never condescending, great at explaining difficult concepts
- Approachable and invested in helping me learn the material.
- Super nice, always willing to meet and discuss grades or projects
- I really appreciated how responsive and willing to help Helen was when emailing her. I always felt that she was trying to help me succeed in the course. I also really appreciated how she would break down the models from lecture and make sure to thoroughly explain each part to make sure we had a solid understanding.
- Helen is very helpful and approachable, always felt comfortable asking her questions. Helen is clear in her explanations, and her notes for sections were always helpful.

How can this instructor's teaching be improved?: Helen Kissel

- Limiting time for discussions that go mildly astray so we can cover the whole section material?
- N/A
- maybe sending a survey out to tailor section towards questions
- Nah
- Maybe spends a little too much on the basics at the beginning of section
- sometimes it was obvious she hadn't read through the problems before in section and didn't know the answer either
- Clarifying any assumptions on a theory before moving forward with them.
- More experience with some of the more specific aspects of topics.
- In-person office hours would have been nice too
- lots of times she couldn't explain the graphs from class, or would say that environmental economics is outside of her field, which made it hard for me to get my questions answered
- N/A
- n/a
- nothing she was great
- Spend more time in class going over the graphs than the broader concepts.
- I don't really have any areas in which I feel Helen could improve.